

VIPUL KATARNWARE

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NAVI MUMBAI, INDIA

Product Manager / B2B SaaS / FinTech / AI Products

SUMMARY

Product Manager who leads with customer discovery: interviewed diners and restaurant owners to find why QRapid's QR menu wasn't converting, then made the sequencing calls that grew it into a native iOS and Android restaurant platform with 26 paying partners and \$240,000+ (INR 2 crore+) in processed transactions. Founded and ran QRapid end to end while separately owning enterprise-scale execution at ICICI Bank, where a Business Rules Engine decision affects millions of loan and credit card applications a year. Uses AI to move faster on execution while keeping customer discovery and product judgment human-led.

EXPERIENCE

QRapid | *Product Lead & Founder, VJTI TBI Incubated*

Sep 2024 – Present / Mumbai, India

- Owned QRapid's restaurant management system end to end, from QR menu through ordering, POS, and billing, shipped as native iOS and Android apps; led a team of up to 10 across engineering, restaurant onboarding, customer support, and go-to-market, growing the platform to 26 paying restaurant partners, 10,000+ registered diners, and \$240,000+ (INR 2 crore+) in processed transactions.
- Launched with a QR menu alone and found scans running well below forecast; interviewed diners and restaurant owners instead of treating it as a marketing problem, and learned that a diner holding a physical menu would only pull out a phone if scanning delivered something the menu could not.
- Defined inbound support-call rate as QRapid's product-health metric, since restaurant operators rarely file feature requests but call the moment service stops, and tracked it weekly alongside feature-request volume; drove it from all 10 of 10 partners calling twice a week at launch to 1-2 of 10 calling once a month by stabilizing critical features and uptime, testing properly, and rolling out through a partner feedback loop.
- Partner activation stalled at 20% until customer interviews revealed prospects only switched POS software when their current subscription neared expiry; retimed outreach to that window, lifting activation conversion to 80% and cutting partner activation time by 30%.
- Ran QCash as an internal 0-to-1 experiment inside QRapid, a cross-merchant loyalty currency whose points belonged to the diner rather than to any single restaurant and could be redeemed across the partner network; the MVP drew interest from 55 restaurants and reached 40 organic users in its first month at a 12.5% repeat-visit rate, with no paid acquisition and no payment gateway, validating demand before deliberately deferring commercialization until the RMS reaches full operational stability.

ICICI Bank | *Product Manager: Policy Manager, Retail Assets and Lending Systems*

Jul 2023 – Aug 2024 / Mumbai, India

- Owned the Business Rules Engine deciding credit eligibility, underwriting, ledger workflows, and financial transaction flows for millions of applications a year, shipping cross-functional policy changes with Risk, Engineering, and Analytics.
- Traced weak pre-approval targeting to one coarse input rather than the decisioning logic: the engine scored an applicant's area on an internal 5-point location rating, but in Mumbai high-rise housing and low-income settlements sit within a few hundred meters, so applicants with very different economic profiles received the same location score.
- Evaluated GeoIQ, an external geospatial intelligence vendor, as a richer address-level input to lending policy; wrote the BRD, aligned Risk, Engineering, Analytics, Compliance, and the vendor team, and led UAT before production rollout, improving campaign approval quality by an estimated 15% with no increase in default rate and lifting eligibility 10-15% for qualified applicants whose addresses had been scored too coarsely (self-reported, not independently audited).
- Specified and shipped major new rule sets on the Business Rules Engine for credit card and personal loan decisioning, covering eligibility, underwriting, and pricing logic evaluated across millions of applications a year.

SELECTED PRODUCTS

CareerOS | github.com/vbkatarnaware/careeros

Workflow redesign for the modern job search, using AI only where it earns its cost.

- Rebuilt CareerOps, an open-source AI job-search agent that exhausted a Claude Pro quota 2-3 times without completing a single pipeline, into CareerOS: an MIT-licensed, from-scratch Python rewrite backed by 700+ automated tests, with roughly as much test code as product code.
- Cut pipeline cost through workflow redesign rather than a bigger model: a free deterministic filter and a batched AI gate, 50 jobs per call against a lean profile subset, triage jobs before full evaluation runs only on survivors, backed by a cache keyed on job content, profile version, and prompt version so no AI call repeats for an answer already computed.
- Moved the deep interview-prep report out of the daily pipeline to an opt-in, on-demand command and forbade it from recomputing the evaluation it expands on, because most discovered jobs never become an actual application; defined the pipeline's KPI as cost per interview-worthy job, where selecting zero jobs on a given day is a correct outcome.

Rizent AI | rizent.me

Investor outreach for founders, run end to end by an AI co-founder. Private beta.

- Solo-built Rizent, a private-beta AI investor-outreach platform for founders, as a 30,000+ line TypeScript monorepo, Next.js, Express, a BullMQ worker, and Postgres across 71 migrations, covering pitch-deck ingestion, AI investor match-scoring, Gmail outreach with scheduled follow-ups, reply-intent detection, and Google Calendar meeting booking behind a founder approval gate.
- Designed a governed memory layer that classifies stored facts as static or dynamic with an expiry policy, so when an investor asks about revenue or runway and the stored figure has gone stale, the agent escalates to the founder over a Telegram bot instead of answering, rather than letting the AI invent a financial number it cannot source.

SKILLS

Product: Product Strategy, Discovery, Roadmapping, Prioritization, PRDs / BRDs, Stakeholder Management, User Research, Experimentation

Growth: GTM Strategy, Activation & Retention, KPI Design, Product-Led Growth (PLG)

AI & Automation: AI Product Strategy, Agentic Workflows, n8n, OpenAI API, Claude API

FinTech: Business Rules Engine (BRE), Credit Decisioning

Analytics: SQL

EDUCATION

B.Tech., Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute (VJTI), Mumbai

7.0 CPI 2019–2023

HSC, V.G. Vaze College of Science, Arts and Commerce

73% 2016–2018

SSC, Little Flower English Convent School

87% 2015–2016